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Dean of Students

MINELL ELLERBE
Certified School Counselor

JULIA REY
Certified School Counselor

July 30, 2026

Dear South Seminole Academy Faculty & Staff,

Welcome back to a new and exciting school year at our Career Exploration Magnet School! It is both an honor and a privilege to serve as your new principal, and I am thrilled to begin this journey alongside such a dedicated and talented team. Whether you are returning to our school family or joining us for the first time, please know that your contributions are valued and appreciated. Together, we have the opportunity to continue building a culture of excellence where students are inspired to discover their passions, explore career pathways, and achieve their fullest potential.

As we reflect on last school year, I want to extend my heartfelt congratulations and gratitude to each of you for your hard work, commitment, and unwavering belief in our students. Because of your dedication, our school earned a school grade that was just 3 percentage points shy of an "A" (551 points/61% B), a remarkable accomplishment that speaks volumes about the quality of instruction, support, and care provided every day. This achievement is a testament to the collective effort of our faculty and staff, and it should fill us all with pride. Thank you for the countless ways you went above and beyond to ensure student success.

As we move forward into this school year, our shared theme will be **"Every Student. Every Point. Every Day."** This theme serves as a reminder that every interaction, every lesson, every intervention, and every moment matters. Our focus will remain on ensuring that every student is supported academically, socially, and emotionally while maintaining high expectations and providing meaningful opportunities for growth. By paying attention to every student's needs, maximizing every opportunity for achievement, and committing to excellence every day, we will continue to elevate our school to even greater heights to achieve our goal of becoming an A-rated school with at least 585 points or 65% school grade.

I am excited about what we will accomplish together and confident that our best days are ahead. Let us embrace this new school year with enthusiasm, collaboration, and a relentless commitment to student success. I look forward to learning, leading, and celebrating with each of you as we work together to make this our strongest year yet. Here's to a fantastic school year filled with growth, achievement, and opportunity for all.

The pre-planning work hours are 8:00 am to 4:00 pm daily. Please remember to sign in at the front office each day. July 31st and August 3rd are optional teacher workdays. Teachers who choose to work on these days will earn comp time, which they can use on specified dates throughout the school year. All teachers are expected to report back on Tuesday, August 4th. Please mark your calendars for the mandatory PD Day on October 12, 2026, and the mandatory district PD Day on January 5, 2027. The campus will be open on Saturday, August 8th, from 9:00 am to 3:00 pm for teachers to work in their classrooms.

I look forward to seeing everyone soon!

Sincerely,
Dr. Clifphene Reid
Principal

